Negative Double

Partner opens 1 of a suit and the next opponent overcalls a suit:
Double by you is not for penalty - it says you **would** have responded if no overcall.
You need 6+ points for 1-level double, more for higher level double
Negative Double promises at least four cards in any unbid Major
If both Majors have been bid, double promises both minors
1♣/♦ - 1♥ - dbl - promises 4-card Spade suit
1♣/♦ - 1♥ - 1♠ - promises 5+ card Spade suit

Support Cue-bid

When partner opens and next player overcalls, a Cue-bid by you shows Limit-raise or better support for partner's suit. Any raise of partner's suit is preemptive and shows LESS than a Limit-raise.

When an opponent opens, partner overcalls, and the next opponent passes, a Cue-bid by you shows Limit-raise or better support for partner's suit. Any raise of partner's suit is preemptive and shows LESS than a Limit-raise.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 2♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥K

Board: 2
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣5

Board: 3
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♠K

Board: 4
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥J

Board: 5
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 2♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥Q

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣5

Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

♠ A K 6 3 2
♥ 9 3
♦ 9 7 2
♣ Q 9 2

♠ 10 5
♥ Q 5 4 2
♦ Q 10 8 5
♣ 8 5 3



♠ J 8 4
♥ A K 10 6
♦ J 4 3
♣ A 7 6

♠ Q 9 7
♥ J 8 7
♦ A K 6
♣ K J 10 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♣
1♥	1♠	Pass	2♠
All Pass			

2♠ by North
Lead: ♥K

Compare this hand with Deal 6. NORTH has five ♠s, this time so she bids 1♠.

SOUTH knows there IS an 8-card fit in ♠s, so he bids 2♠.

NORTH has 10 points so she passes.

Board 2
North Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ K J 8 6 ♥ 6 5 ♦ 10 8 3 2 ♣ 8 7 3	
♠ 9 7 ♥ K 8 7 4 ♦ K Q 6 ♣ K 10 9 4		♠ A 5 2 ♥ A Q 10 9 3 ♦ 9 7 ♣ A J 2
	♠ Q 10 4 3 ♥ J 2 ♦ A J 5 4 ♣ Q 6 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	Pass	1♥	1♠
2♠	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			

4♥ by East
Lead: ♣5

WEST has 11/12 points, a Limit Raise in ♥s. So after the overcall he makes a Support Cue-bid of 2♠.

EAST adds her 16 to the 11 that WEST has promised as a minimum and goes straight to 4♥.

If WEST had significantly more than 11 he could bid on, but in this case he should happily pass.

Board 3
East Deals
E-W Vul

♠ 9 7
♥ K 8 7 4
♦ 10 8 6
♣ K 10 9 4

♠ K Q 10 3
♥ J 5
♦ A Q 5 2
♣ 8 6 5



♠ A J 6 4
♥ 6 2
♦ K J 4 3
♣ J 7 3

♠ 8 5 2
♥ A Q 10 9 3
♦ 9 7
♣ A Q 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		Pass	1♥
1♠	3♥		
All Pass			

3♥ by South
Lead: ♠K

Compare this with Deal 8.

NORTH has 7 points, barely enough for a 2♥ raise if there had been no overcall. But when WEST puts in the ♠ bid, NORTH can jump to 3♥ as a preemptive measure. He knows SOUTH won't think he has strength because he did not make a Support Cue-bid.

SOUTH does know it and passes 3♥.

Board 4
South Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 5 4 ♥ J 10 2 ♦ A J 5 4 2 ♣ 9 7 5	
♠ A K 9 7 3 ♥ 6 4 ♦ 6 3 ♣ K J 10 4		♠ Q 8 6 2 ♥ A K 9 3 ♦ 9 7 ♣ A 8 2
	♠ J 10 ♥ Q 8 7 5 ♦ K Q 10 8 ♣ Q 6 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
1♠	Pass	2♦	Pass
3♠	Pass	4♠	
All Pass			

4♠ by West
Lead: ♥J

EAST has the strength for a raise to game in ♠s, but this could be dangerous since WEST has overcalled rather than opened. Instead, EAST shows her strength with a Support Cue-bid.

WEST in fact had a pretty good overcall so he jumps to 3♠ and EAST bids the game.

With a weak overcall WEST would have just returned to 2♠ which EAST would pass.

Board 5
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ A K 9 7 3 ♥ 6 5 4 ♦ Q 3 ♣ 7 6 3	
♠ 5 4 ♥ 8 7 2 ♦ A K 10 5 2 ♣ K Q 10	N W E S	♠ J 10 ♥ Q J 10 ♦ J 8 6 4 ♣ J 9 5 4
	♠ Q 8 6 2 ♥ A K 9 3 ♦ 9 7 ♣ A 8 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♦	1♠	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠		
All Pass			

2♠ by North
Lead: ♥Q

Compare this to Deal 10.

SOUTH has the strength for a raise to game in ♠s, but this could be dangerous since NORTH has overcalled rather than opened. Instead, SOUTH shows her strength with a Support Cue-bid.

NORTH has very minimal overcall so he just bids 2♠ which SOUTH passes.

Board 6
East Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A J 10 9 6
♥ 5 4
♦ 5 3
♣ J 9 4 3

♠ Q 7 5
♥ Q J 9 3
♦ A 10 8 2
♣ Q 8



♠ 8
♥ A K 10 8 7
♦ K Q J 4
♣ A K 6

♠ K 4 3 2
♥ 6 2
♦ 9 7 6
♣ 10 7 5 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	1♠
2♠	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♦[2]	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♥ by East
Lead: ♣5

EAST has a maximum 1♥ opening bid.

WEST would have made a Limit Raise in ♥s, but after SOUTH's overcall she makes a Support Cue-bid instead.

EAST thinks there may be a slam and bids 4NT Blackwood to check for Aces. When WEST admits to one Ace EAST bids the slam.